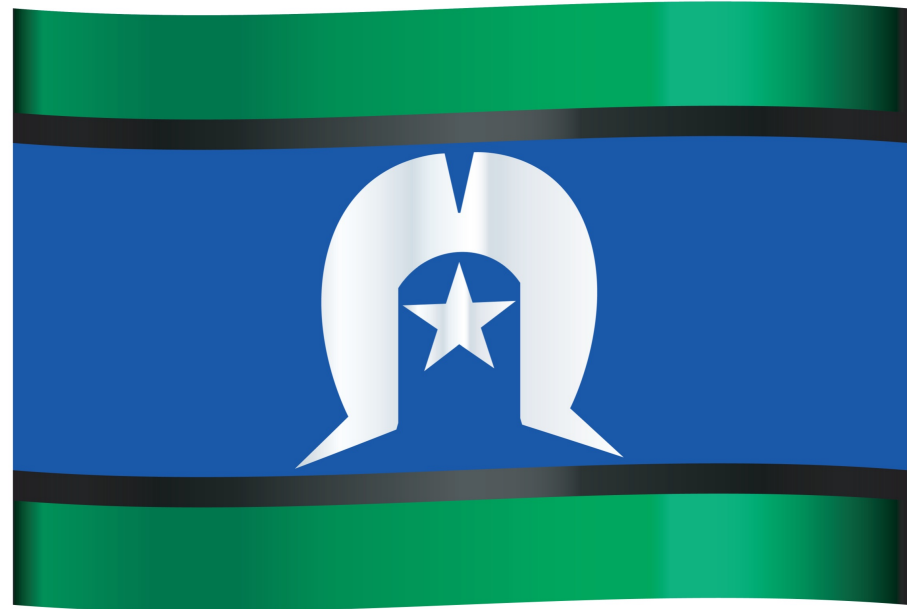


A photograph of two women standing outdoors in a grassy area with trees in the background. They are both smiling and looking at a book held by the woman on the left. The woman on the left has dark hair in a ponytail and is wearing a white t-shirt and a patterned scarf. The woman on the right has brown hair in a ponytail and is wearing a black cardigan over a floral top. The book has a green cover with a white pattern. The text 'Professional Learning Workshop' is overlaid on the bottom left of the image in a large, bold, white font.

Professional Learning Workshop

Education Support Staff

Acknowledgement of Country



A close-up photograph of two hands, one from a lighter-skinned person and one from a darker-skinned person, both holding and pouring bright red soil. The hands are positioned one above the other, with a stream of soil falling from the upper hand into the lower one. The background is a blurred natural setting with green foliage and a clear blue sky. The overall tone is symbolic and peaceful.

Statement of reconciliation

First Nations people are advised that this workshop may contain images and voices of people who are no longer with us.



Everyone is welcome at this workshop. We want you to feel that it is ok to be authentically yourself.

Please let us know if there is anything we can do that helps to include you in the workshop.

Everyone is welcome to use their own strategies to help them engage and to participate effectively.



Housekeeping



Tea / Coffee



Exits



Facilities



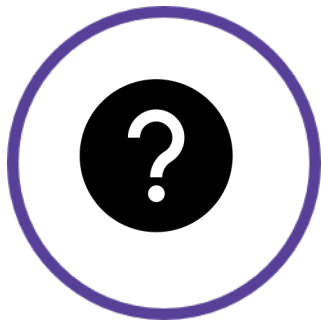
Phones



No Smoking / Vaping



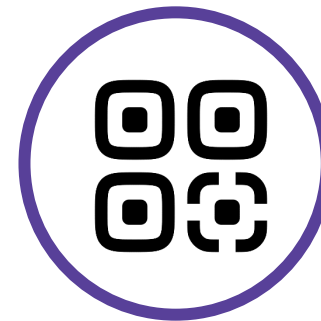
Personal Needs



Questions



Workbook



Other Information



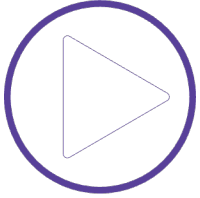
Evaluation

Think about your students



Bring two or three students to mind, ideally students who are quite different from each other.

- What are you here for?
- What would you like to understand better?
- What strengths, interests or moments of connection should stay visible?



Student voice

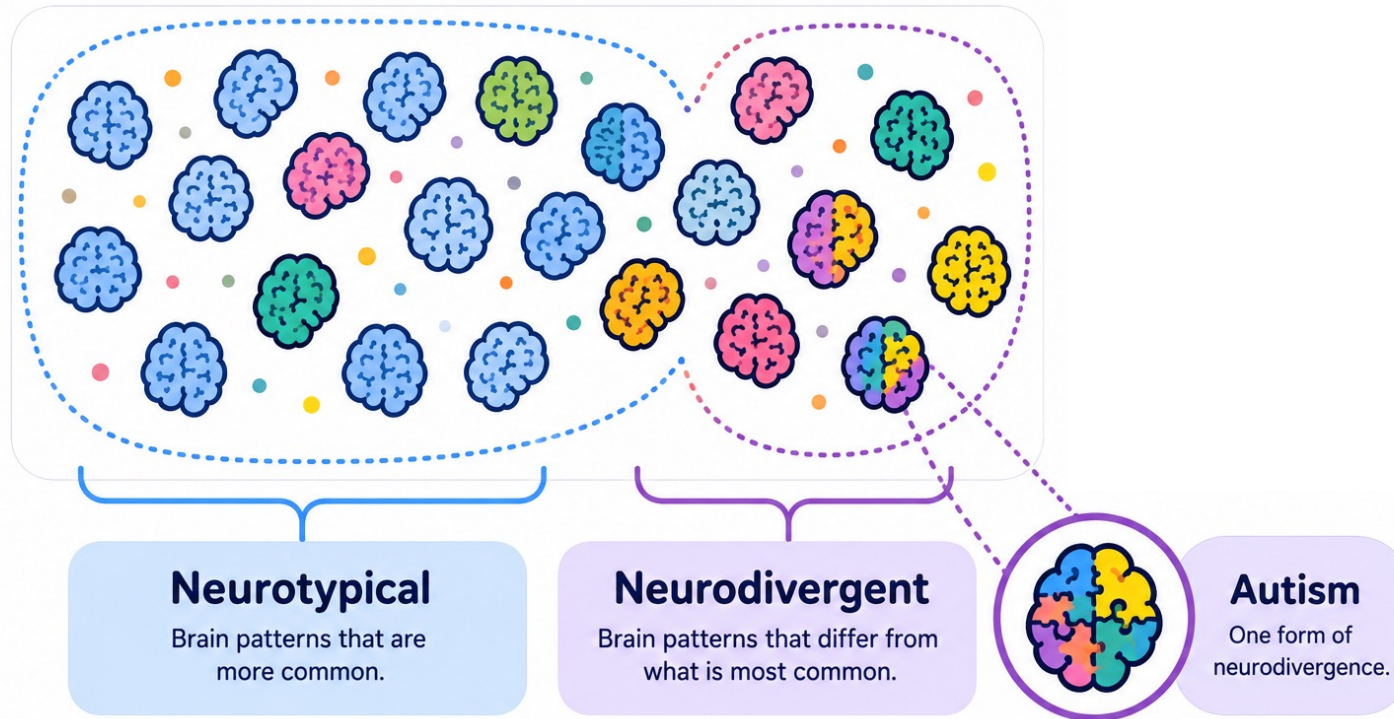


What did you notice?



- What stayed with you?
- What would you like to understand more deeply?

Neurodiversity and neurodivergence



Neurodiversity is the whole picture.

Neurotypical and neurodivergent describe brain patterns within neurodiversity.

Autism is one expression of that diversity.

Neurodiversity affirming

**Differences
are not
deficits**

Acknowledging
different ways of
knowing, doing, being
and belonging

All people have
strengths and
experience challenges

There is no right or
wrong way to think,
learn or behave

Everyone experiences
and interacts with the
world differently

The social model

Use an environment-first lens:

Look for barriers in places, tasks, routines and expectations

Ask what can change around the student

Include the student's communication and experience when judging access

Review whether the change makes participation more workable

Look again at school

School routines reflect ideas about participation and learning. Consider:

- **What is school for?**
- **Who is school for?**
- **How do students learn?**
- **Whose ways of communicating, moving and participating are treated as expected?**



Discussion



Choose one familiar routine or decision.

- Which assumptions shape it?
- Who can access it easily?
- Where might the environment create a barrier?
- How could curiosity change the next response?

Discuss systems and routines, not identifiable students or colleagues.

The law: access, participation and inclusion

Disability Discrimination Act 1992

Makes it unlawful to treat a person unfairly because of disability, including in education.

Disability Standards for Education 2005

Students with disability have the right to take part in education on the same basis as other students.

What that asks of schools

Consult the student, or an associate such as a parent or carer. Make reasonable adjustments. Prevent harassment and victimisation.

Disability Standards for Education (DSE) 2005



Autism as difference

Dynamic disability

A student's access and support needs may change with the task, environment, relationships and available capacity.

Fluctuating capacity

Today's workshop

- 1 Use a neurodiversity-affirming approach
 - 2 Understand Autistic experience
 - 3 Notice experience across the school day
 - 4 Design more accessible learning environments
 - 5 Work in partnership
- 